

Dear Members of the Admissions Committee,

I am pleased to recommend Loukas Mertzanis for admission to the MSc in Advanced Cybersecurity Technologies and Governance at the University of Piraeus.

I managed Loukas during our time at Sitecore, where he worked in DevOps and platform engineering and progressed to a Senior DevOps Engineer role. This gave me the opportunity to observe his technical ability, sound judgement, and capacity to take ownership of important systems.

Loukas's responsibilities included GitHub governance, CI/CD standards, and engineering infrastructure supporting more than 1,000 repositories and 500 developers. He also made particularly strong contributions to Sitecore's internal developer platform, developing self-service workflows for creating, configuring, and deploying microservices to Kubernetes.

Loukas was also selected for a focused DevOps Tiger Team responsible for deploying Sitecore cloud products into the Azure US Central region under significant capacity constraints. The team successfully completed the rollout in under one month, demonstrating his ability to contribute effectively in a technically demanding and operationally sensitive environment.

In my experience, Loukas approaches difficult problems methodically, learns quickly, and communicates clearly with both engineers and stakeholders. His work in cloud platforms, automation, governance, and secure software delivery gives him an excellent practical foundation for advanced study in cybersecurity.

I am confident that Loukas will contribute mature engineering experience to the programme while benefiting from its deeper treatment of security architecture, risk, and governance.

Sincerely,

Dimitrios Kounalakis

Chief Information Security Officer, Epignosis

Former manager of Loukas Mertzanis at Sitecore

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